

Wikipedia for Careers: Mapping the Invisible

Solving the opacity of success and the crisis of social mobility

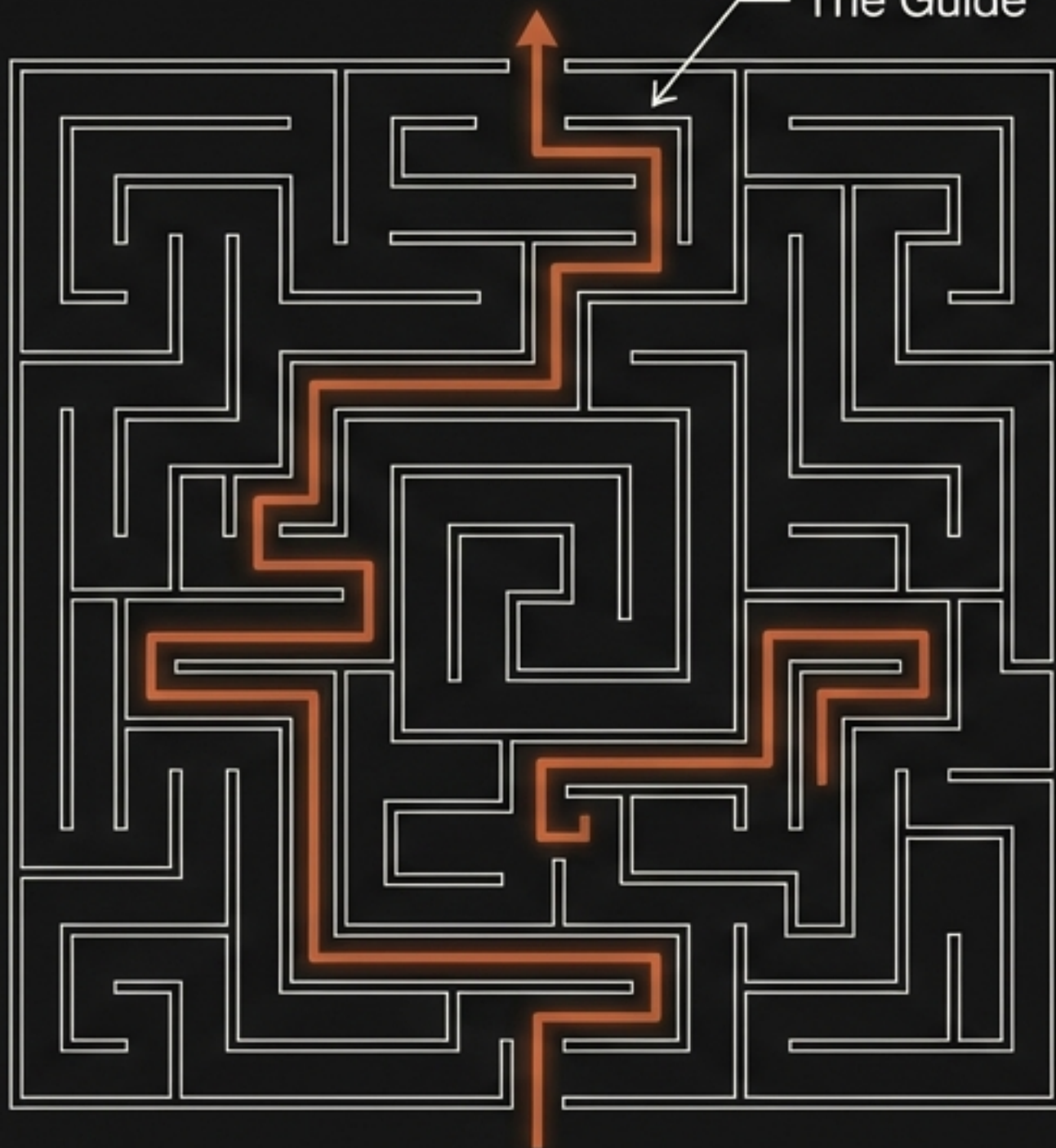


The Opacity Gap

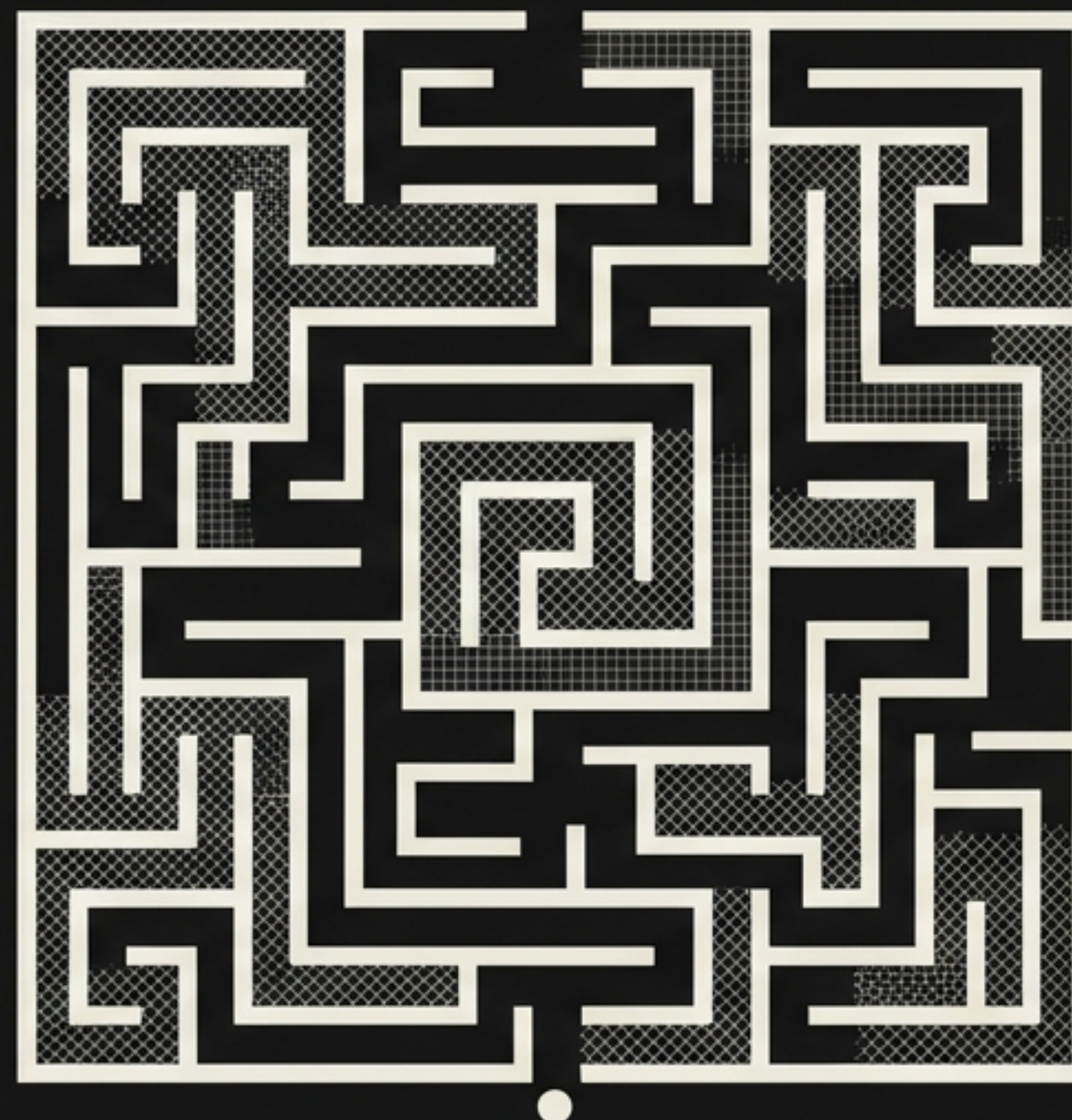
Most career paths—becoming a surgeon, a CISO, a barrister—are invisible from the inside. Privilege is often simply “access to a guide” who fills the gap with informal knowledge. For everyone else, the path isn’t just opaque; it looks inaccessible. This is the core of the social mobility problem.

The Insider

The Guide



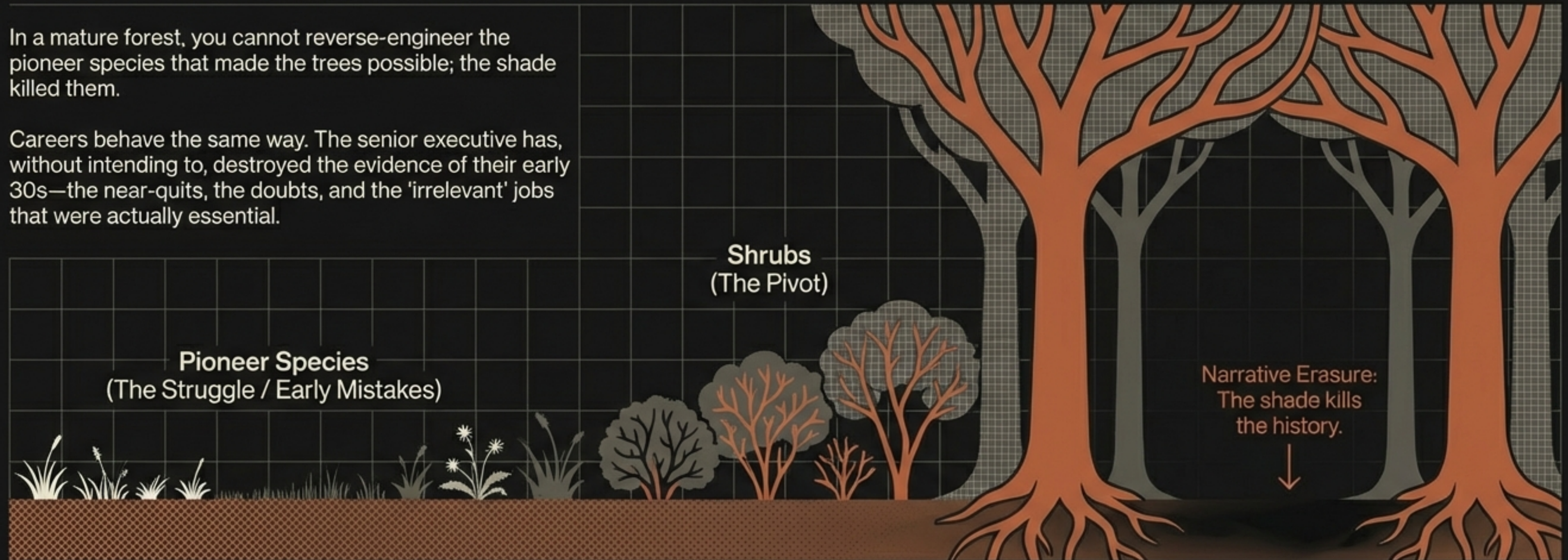
The Outsider



The Forest destroys its own history by growing.

In a mature forest, you cannot reverse-engineer the pioneer species that made the trees possible; the shade killed them.

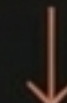
Careers behave the same way. The senior executive has, without intending to, destroyed the evidence of their early 30s—the near-quits, the doubts, and the 'irrelevant' jobs that were actually essential.



Mature Canopy
(The Success)

Shrubs
(The Pivot)

Narrative Erasure:
The shade kills
the history.



Pioneer Species
(The Struggle / Early Mistakes)

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(The Struggle / Early Mistakes)

Shrubs
(The Pivot)

Mature Canopy
(The Success)

Narrative Compression.

Success stories are told forward ("I aimed for X and got X"). They are lived backward. The official biography removes the recursion and uncertainty, leaving a sanitized path that is impossible to follow.

The LinkedIn Bio
(Told Forward)



The Reality
(Lived Backward)



Trespasser Syndrome vs. Imposter Syndrome

Imposter Syndrome is the fear of being found out after you succeed.

Trespasser Syndrome is the belief that you do not belong before you even try. It is the false sense that a professional community is not meant for “people like you”.



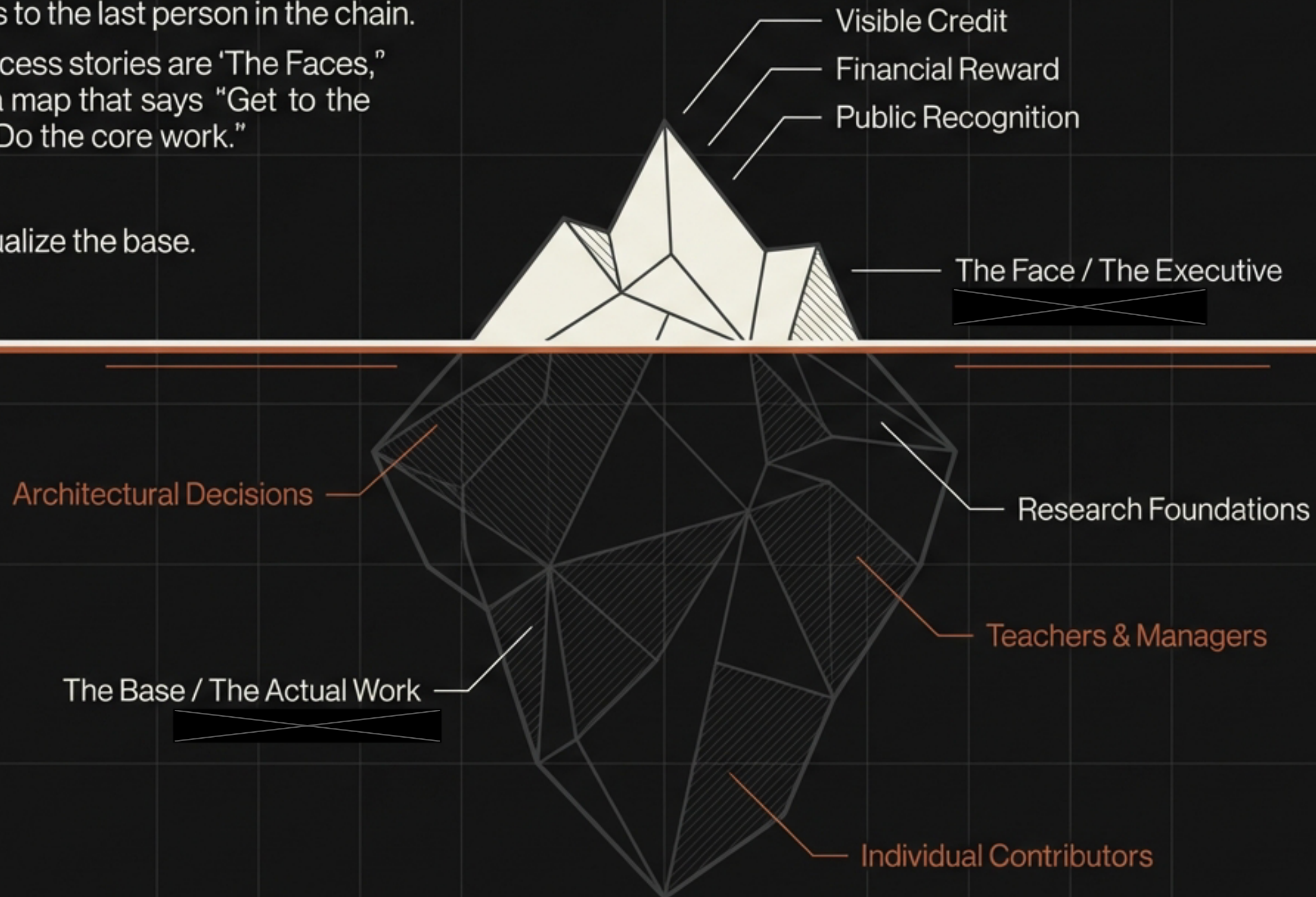
“The evidence shows that people from non-traditional backgrounds frequently outperform their peers. But you can only believe it if you see it.”

The Last-Mile Credit Distortion.

We attribute success to the last person in the chain.

If the only visible success stories are 'The Faces,' young people build a map that says "Get to the top" – rather than "Do the core work."

A true map must visualize the base.



The Proposal: Wikipedia for Careers

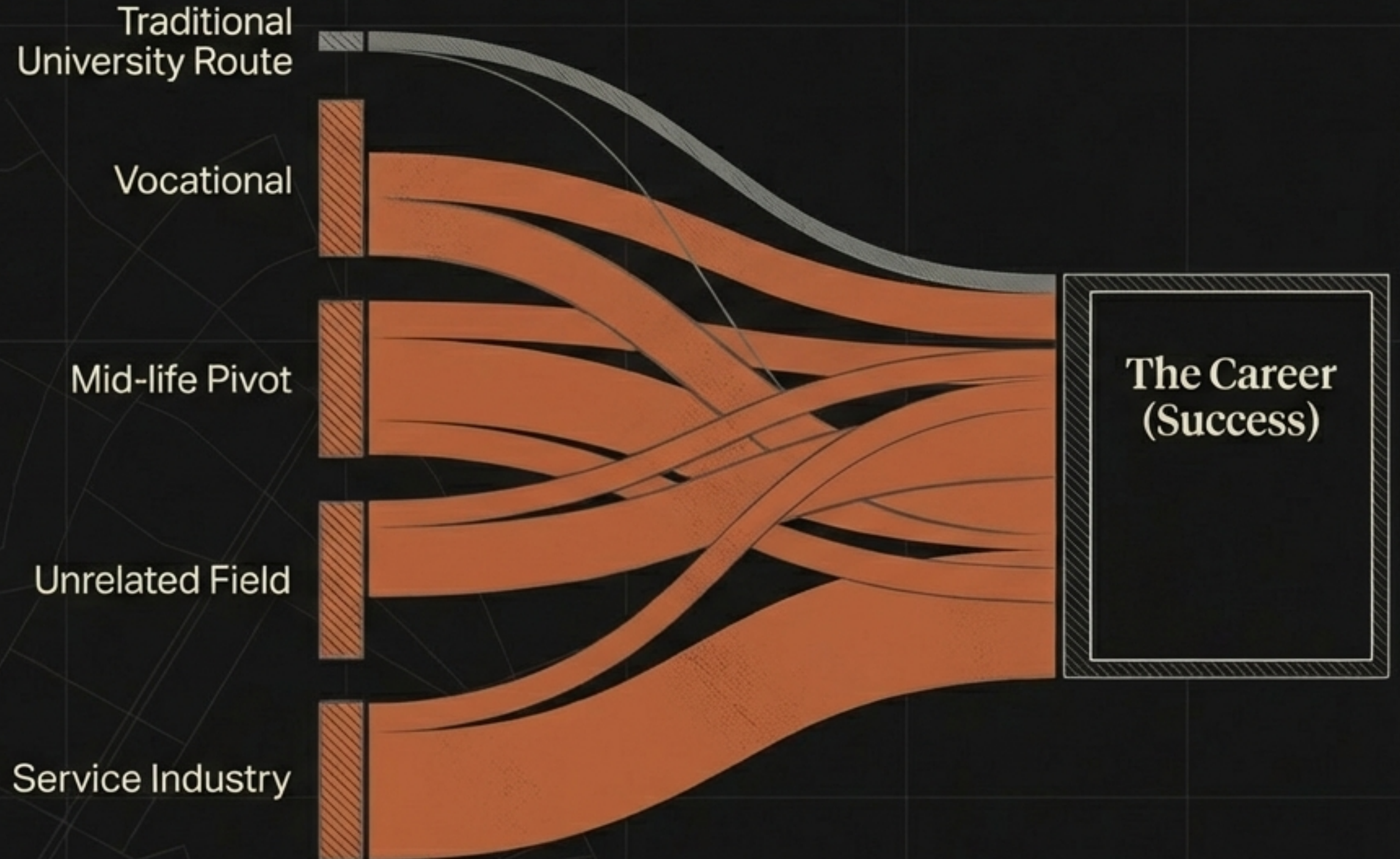
A structured, open, community-built body of knowledge. It answers one question:
What does it actually take to succeed, and what paths have people actually taken?
Not the brochure version. The version with the false starts, the doubts, and the
things that actually mattered.

How do I actually get here? ■

Community-edited. Open Source. The Real Version.

Anatomy of an Entry: The Truth.

- **The Common Paths:** The full distribution, not just the outlier success stories.
- **The Hidden Accelerators:** The specific experiences or relationships that made the difference, often invisible in a CV.
- **Cross-Career Connections:** Which 'irrelevant' backgrounds produce superpowers in this field?

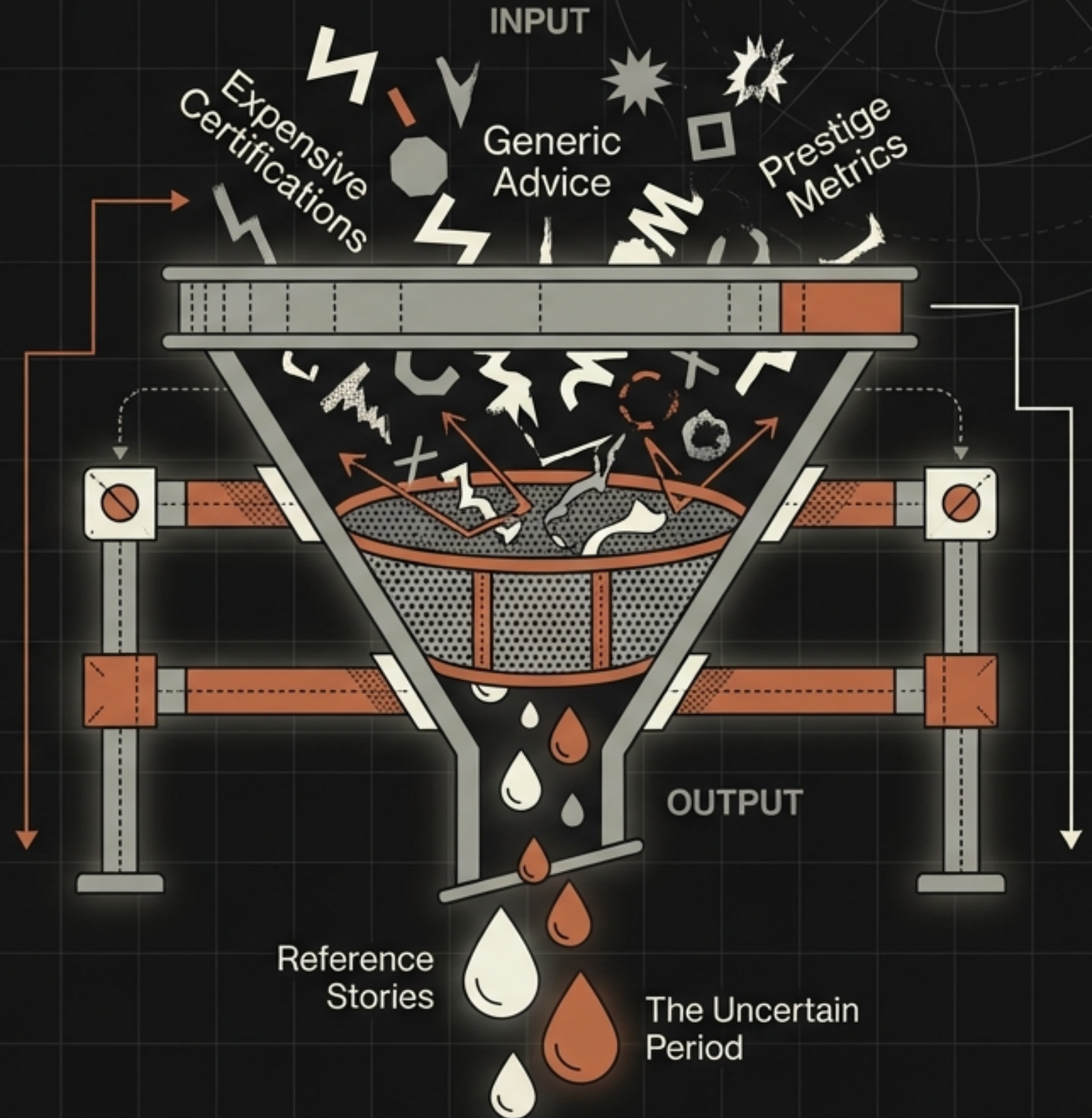


Anatomy of an Entry: The Signals

False Signals: Credentials that look impressive but have zero correlation with performance.

Reference Stories: Interviews focusing on pivots and mistakes.

We need the “uncertain period” documented to prove that the path is survivable.





Why Open Source? Trust is the Currency.

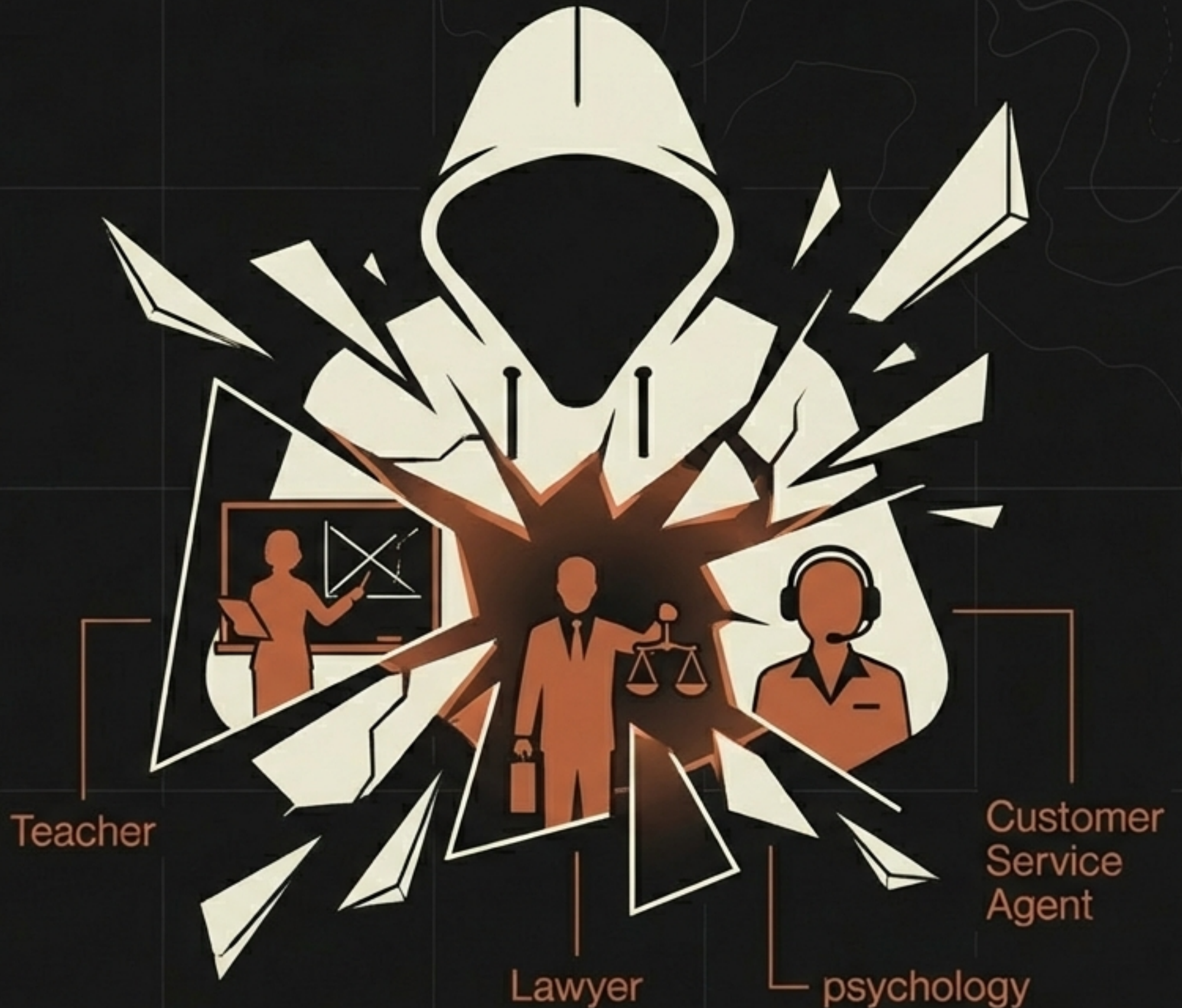
1. **Honesty requires safety:** People will not share vulnerability with an organization that monetizes their story.
2. **Compounding value:** An open database can be remixed, analyzed, and extended infinitely.
3. **Collective scale:** Proprietary solutions have failed for decades. Social mobility is a collective problem requiring a non-proprietary patch.

Case Study: Cybersecurity.

The dominant narrative demands certifications and a technical degree.

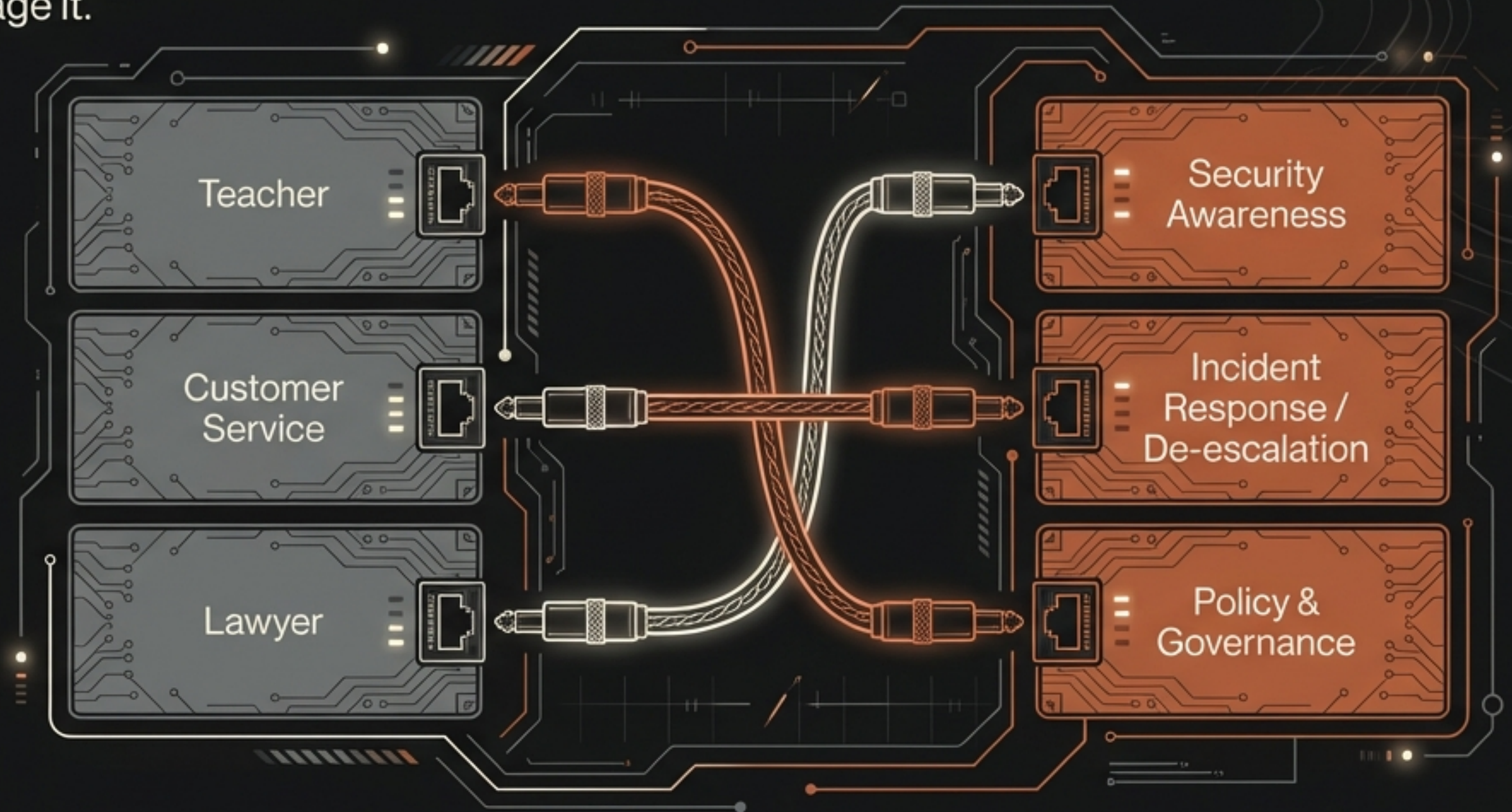
The reality? The best pros often come from law (risk analysis), teaching (communication), or psychology (behavioral modelling).

We must show that “outsiders” don’t just belong; they are carrying the exact skills the industry is missing.



The Outsider Advantage

Resilience, perspective, and the ability to see the system from the outside are competitive advantages. When we map these transfer points, we stop asking people to hide their past and start asking them to leverage it.



Proof of Possibility.

"You can only believe it if you see it." Breaking a ceiling doesn't just create a single success; it creates a generation who now believe the ceiling is breakable. Representation is evidence.



The Invitation.

The technical infrastructure is the easy part. We need the knowledge. We need interviews, research, and domain expertise. We are looking for those willing to do the patient, unfashionable work of building a body of knowledge that outlasts any individual.



“The path is not just opaque.
It looks actively inaccessible...
This is solvable.”



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